These were meant not just to preserve existing knowledge of ancient Indian art forms, but to encourage young people to learn and practise them. Some museums and the Archaeological Survey of India had already been set up by the British and now institutions were now set up and policies made to ensure the conservation of India's historical monuments and artefacts.

There were also many programmes aimed at reviving the traditional handicrafts industry, which had suffered during the British colonial period. Knowledge of the methods used was largely confined to the small communities that produced these items, and there was an urgent need to revive dying crafts and techniques and help support the people who engaged in making handloom and handicraft artefacts.

The individuals in this section are just a few of the many people who worked towards preserving India's centuries-old cultural and artistic heritage.

KAMALADEVI CHATTOPADHYAY

1903–1988